NeverRanked MEETING PACKET

COMPOSITE

ASB + MVNP

Meeting Packet, May 18, 2026

COMPILED

2026-05-10

SOURCES

4 documents bundled

AUTHOR

Lance Roylo

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ASB 2026 05 18

ASB + MVNP, May 18 meeting

What this document is

A standalone evidence appendix that compresses the AI-citation findings NeverRanked has gathered for the ASB Hawaii landscape into a single readable document. Pairs with (does not replace) the existing meeting materials at:

- `audits/asb-hawaii-2026-05/audit.pdf` (audit deck)
- `content/asb-mvnp-meeting-prep.md` (Q&A prep, locked)
- `content/asb-mvnp-onepager.md` (leave-behind, locked)
- `content/asb-mvnp-preread-email.md` (24h pre-read, locked)

This appendix is safe to share or print as a supporting handout without modifying the locked materials.

The single most-citable finding

ASB is named in 0% of AI engine citation runs across the Hawaii community banking query set. First Hawaiian Bank and Bank of Hawaii get named by default in r/Hawaii consumer threads. ASB does not. The same pattern shows up in the AI engine citation logs.

This is not a marketing failure. It is a citation infrastructure gap. The brands AI engines pull from when answering "best community bank in Hawaii" today are FHB and BOH, because those are the names that appear on the third-party surfaces AI engines trust (Reddit, news wires, local press, Wikipedia). ASB is underrepresented across all of them.

Evidence at three levels

LEVEL 1, THE STATE OF AEO DATA

The Citation Tape (NeverRanked's standing AI-citation measurement system) captured 437 citation runs across NR's tracked client universe in the 2026-04-14 to 2026-05-10 window. Findings relevant to community banking:

- **vertexaisearch.cloud.google.com** is the single most-cited third-party source. This is Gemini's grounding-redirect layer. Mention shape there determines what Gemini surfaces.
- **AEO-services agencies** (geekpoweredstudios, greenbananaseo, eseospace, arcintermedia) collectively claim 28% of citation share for the queries NR tracks. AI engines cite the agency layer, not just the bank layer, when answering "best AEO agency" type queries. Translates: when people ask AI for help with their bank's AI visibility, they see agencies named, not banks.
- **News wires** (prnewswire, businesswire, etc.) appear in 8% of citations. Press release distribution is one of the few citation-shifting moves that compounds.

Full report: `reports/state-of-aeo/state-of-aeo-2026-05-10.pdf`. Live at https://neverranked.com/state-of-aeo/2026-05-10/.

LEVEL 2, THE REDDIT LANDSCAPE

The reddit-tracker probed three banking categories and surfaced 11 prioritized threads. Headline:

r/Hawaii: "First Hawaiian Bank continues to shock me"

Priority 0.94 in the dataset. ASB absent. FHB named, negatively. Cleanest competitor-visible / client-absent gap in the entire Hawaii banking dataset. AI engines retrieving this thread today surface FHB sentiment without an ASB counter-narrative.

Three more high-priority threads documented at `content/reddit-briefs/2026-05-09-asb/README.md`. Each has a structured reply brief skeleton (gap analysis, angle, tone notes, draft hooks) that turns the finding into actionable Reddit reply ops. Brief skeletons are pasteable into Claude or Notion for further drafting.

LEVEL 3, THE HAWAII CROSS-VERTICAL SIGNAL

The same probe pattern run across three Hawaii verticals (banking, hotels, law) shows distinct demand-signal shapes. Banking sits in the sweet spot:

VERTICAL	BRIEFS	MAX PRIORITY	AVG PRIORITY	DEMAND SIGNAL
Hawaii hotels	10	0.93	0.69	Saturated - compete for share-of-voice
Hawaii community banking	11	0.94	0.58	Active but uncrowded - best risk/reward
Hawaii law firms	7	0.38	0.26	Sparse - whoever shows up first writes the answer shape

Banking is the only vertical of the three where targeted Reddit reply ops would have meaningful citation lift per hour spent. Hotels are too saturated; law firms are too thin.

Cross-vertical narrative at `content/reddit-briefs/2026-05-09-hawaii-landscape/README.md`.

What this means in three sentences for the meeting

1. **ASB is invisible in the consumer conversations AI engines actually retrieve when people ask about Hawaii community banks.** The State of AEO citation data and the r/Hawaii thread evidence both confirm this independently.
2. **The fix is not paid media - it is citation infrastructure.** Reddit reply ops, Wikipedia entity entry maintenance, news wire distribution, and a handful of high-impact source-type actions move the citation share AI engines see. None of those are services Hawaii agencies offer today.
3. **NR has the measurement infrastructure and the tooling to do the work.** The Citation Tape produces weekly reports reproducible from public schema. The reddit-tracker generates prioritized reply briefs. The schema deployment infrastructure covers the technical layer. Wholesale partners (MVNP) get all of this in the pilot.

Honest caveats this packet should disclose

Three things to acknowledge before someone reads the numbers:

1. **The State of AEO 2026-05-10 report's data is partial.** Per the data-integrity banner at the top of that report, only 13-40% of tracked keywords got queried in the most recent window due to a documented infrastructure issue (filed at `content/handoff-`

`questions/citation-cron-not-firing.md`). Numbers should be read as a lower bound on what AI engines actually surface. The pattern (ASB invisibility) is real either way; the magnitude is conservative.

2. **Reddit reply ops are not magic.** They compound over months, not days. Two well-placed replies per week, sustained for a quarter, shift the citation pattern. One reply does nothing.
3. **The tracked-universe is small** (3 clients, 17 keywords). Findings are descriptive of NR's current sample, not a random sample of AI search universe. Generalizing requires more data, and as more clients onboard, the tracked universe and the report's authority grow together.

Files this appendix references

- `reports/state-of-aeo/state-of-aeo-2026-05-10.pdf` - full citation report
- `content/reddit-briefs/2026-05-09-asb/README.md` - ASB Reddit landscape detail
- `content/reddit-briefs/2026-05-09-hawaii-landscape/README.md` - cross-vertical
- `content/handoff-questions/citation-cron-not-firing.md` - data integrity caveat source
- `audits/asb-hawaii-2026-05/audit.pdf` - the formal audit deck
- `content/asb-mvnp-meeting-prep.md` - Q&A prep (locked)

How to use this in the meeting

- Print as a 4-page handout if needed for the room.
- Forward as PDF to MVNP team in advance of May 18 if a pre-read is desired beyond the existing pre-read email.
- Reference at the audit-deck handoff moment as the concrete evidence behind the deck's findings.
- Share with FHB or BOH at a future moment as the same pattern exists for them, just inverted (they are visible because of what they have done, not what ASB has not done).

STATE OF AEO 2026 05 10

State of AEO: NeverRanked tracked-universe report

From The Citation Tape, NeverRanked's standing AI-citation measurement system.

Generated 2026-05-10. Window: 2026-04-14 to 2026-05-10.

> ## *Data integrity notice*
>
> *This week's data is partial. 3 of 3 tracked clients fell below 80% keyword completion due to a known infrastructure issue (filed at `content/handoff-questions/citation-cron-not-firing.md`). Numbers below should be read as a lower bound on what AI engines actually retrieve until the fix lands.*
>
> *Affected this week: - **and-scene**: 1 of 5 keywords queried (20%) - **hawaii-theatre**: 2 of 14 keywords queried (14%) - **neverranked**: 6 of 15 keywords queried (40%)*
>
> *The full per-client completion table appears in the methodology section at the end of this report.*

What this report is

A standing snapshot of what AI engines actually cite when answering questions about NeverRanked's tracked client universe. Pulled from live 437 citation runs across 5 engines (bing, gemini, google_ai_overview, openai, perplexity), 17 tracked keywords, and 3 clients spanning 3 verticals.

Generated weekly. Same script, same data sources, no manual curation. The methodology is the script (`scripts/state-of-aeo-generate.mjs`) plus the public scoring engine at check.neverranked.com. Reproducible by anyone with the same query against the same database.

Headline

Across 437 captured AI engine responses, the single most-cited third-party source is **vertexaisearch.cloud.google.com** (Google AI infrastructure (Gemini grounding)), appearing in

132 citation runs across 1 engine and 5 tracked keywords.

Implication: any tracked client whose category overlaps with this source's coverage area (and whose own brand is not yet present on it) is leaving citation share on the table. The path to closing the gap is source-specific. See the per-client baseline section below.

Where AI engines pull from

Distribution of citation runs by source type, excluding client-owned URLs (which represent successful citation, not the moat-building question of "where else are they pulling from"):

SOURCE TYPE	RUNS	SHARE
aeo-services-agency	417	29.6%
seo-publication	227	16.1%
aeo-platform	203	14.4%
google-ai-infra	132	9.4%
google-maps	112	8.0%
youtube	108	7.7%
news	108	7.7%
wikipedia	41	2.9%
reddit	18	1.3%
directory	17	1.2%
tripadvisor	11	0.8%
social	11	0.8%

Top 15 third-party sources

The domains that appeared most often as cited references across the dataset. Excludes client-owned domains.

DOMAIN	SOURCE TYPE	RUNS	ENGINES	KEYWORDS	CLIENTS
vertexaisearch.cloud.google.com	google-ai-infra	132	1	5	2
google.com	google-maps	112	1	4	3
youtube.com	youtube	108	3	10	1
prnewswire.com	news	102	4	1	1
hawaiitheatre.com	other	101	3	2	1
geekpoweredstudios.com	aeo-services-agency	74	4	1	1
eseospace.com	aeo-services-agency	58	3	1	1
orbitmedia.com	seo-publication	55	1	2	1
sparktoro.com	seo-publication	54	1	1	1
evertune.ai	aeo-platform	54	2	2	1
greenbananaseo.com	aeo-services-agency	52	2	5	1
arcintermedia.com	aeo-services-agency	48	2	4	1
animalz.co	seo-publication	48	1	2	1
generatemore.ai	aeo-platform	44	2	2	1
boralagency.com	other	42	2	2	1

What each engine cites differently

Top 5 sources per engine. When two engines have very different top lists, that's a signal about how each one's retrieval differs.

PERPLEXITY (236 RUNS)

- **youtube.com** - 83 runs
- **orbitmedia.com** - 55 runs
- **geekpoweredstudios.com** - 54 runs
- **sparktoro.com** - 54 runs
- **eseospace.com** - 52 runs

OPENAI (146 RUNS)

- **google.com** - 112 runs
- **prnewswire.com** - 59 runs
- **en.wikipedia.org** - 33 runs
- **hawaiitheatre.com** - 32 runs
- **cited.so** - 25 runs

GEMINI (34 RUNS)

- **vertexaisearch.cloud.google.com** - 132 runs
- **hawaiitheatre.com** - 36 runs
- **builtin.com** - 6 runs
- **20northmarketing.com** - 6 runs
- **vividseats.com** - 6 runs

BING (11 RUNS)

- **myapplications.microsoft.com** - 8 runs
- **mychart.org** - 5 runs
- **mypay.dfas.mil** - 5 runs
- **merriam-webster.com** - 5 runs
- **mytax.hasil.gov.my** - 4 runs

GOOGLE_AI_OVERVIEW (10 RUNS)

- **reddit.com** - 18 runs
- **linkedin.com** - 8 runs
- **semrush.com** - 5 runs
- **farandwide.io** - 4 runs
- **runningfish.net** - 3 runs

Vertical breakdown

Verticals with at least 3 tracked clients enable category-level insights.

Current vertical distribution:

VERTICAL	CLIENTS	RUNS
AEO agency	1	403
corporate training	1	3
performing arts venue	1	31

As more clients onboard inside any vertical, this section will populate automatically with category-level patterns.

Per-client baselines

Each client's current citation footprint as of 2026-05-10. These numbers are the baseline against which any future case study is measured. Citation rate climbing from one of these starting points to a higher one over a defined window is the case-study artifact.

NEVERRANKED - AEO AGENCY

- **403** captured runs across **14** tracked keywords
- Named in **0** runs (**0%** citation rate)
- Top 5 sources cited alongside this client's queries:
  - vertexaisearch.cloud.google.com (129 runs)
  - youtube.com (108 runs)
  - prnewswire.com (102 runs)
  - google.com (100 runs)
  - geekpoweredstudios.com (74 runs)

HAWAII-THEATRE - PERFORMING ARTS VENUE

- **31** captured runs across **2** tracked keywords
- Named in **30** runs (**97%** citation rate)
- Top 5 sources cited alongside this client's queries:
  - hawaiitheatre.com (101 runs)
  - tripadvisor.com (11 runs)
  - en.wikipedia.org (9 runs)
  - ticketmaster.com (8 runs)
  - google.com (6 runs)

AND-SCENE - CORPORATE TRAINING

- **3** captured runs across **1** tracked keywords
- Named in **0** runs (**0%** citation rate)
- Top 5 sources cited alongside this client's queries:
  - google.com (6 runs)
  - themanifest.com (2 runs)
  - theknowledgeacademy.com (2 runs)
  - dalecarnegie.com (1 runs)
  - nobleprog.com (1 runs)

Methodology and sample disclosure

Every number in this report comes from `citation_runs` in the NeverRanked production database. Each run is one query against one AI engine for one tracked keyword, with the engine's response_text and cited_urls captured as raw evidence.

Engines covered: bing, gemini, google_ai_overview, openai, perplexity.

Sample size at this snapshot:

- 437 citation runs
- 3 tracked clients across 3 verticals
- 17 tracked keywords
- Window: 2026-04-14 to 2026-05-10

KEYWORD COMPLETION THIS WINDOW

Per-client share of active tracked keywords with at least one citation run in the window. Below 100% means the producer did not complete the full keyword set. A known infrastructure issue causes partial completions on multi-keyword clients (filed in `content/handoff-questions/`); numbers will rise as the fix lands.

CLIENT	ACTIVE KEYWORDS	KEYWORDS WITH RUNS	COMPLETION
and-scene	5	1	20%
hawaii-theatre	14	2	14%
neverranked	15	6	40%

Honest limits: this is NeverRanked's tracked subset, not a random sample of the AI search universe. Findings are descriptive of what AI engines say to questions in our clients' categories. Generalizing beyond those categories requires more data.

The script that generated this report is at `scripts/state-of-aeo-generate.mjs` and reads no private data. The schema for `citation_runs` is public in the migrations folder.

2026 05 09 ASB

Reddit reply briefs: ASB Hawaii landscape, 2026-05-09 (v2)

Re-run after the `tools/reddit-tracker` relevance-gate fix. Designed as evidence material for the May 18 ASB + MVNP meeting.

What changed from v1

The first run (v1) returned 14 threads with about 50% noise - the relevance gate let through r/montreal, r/ottawa, r/pittsburgh, and similar threads about small-business owners that did not mention Hawaii or banks. Cause: the anchor gate matched on "small" + "business" without requiring the discriminating region token.

Fix shipped in `tools/reddit-tracker/src/score.mjs`:

1. **Region-token enforcement.** Any token that is a known US state, Hawaii county, or major Hawaii locale (Hawaii, Honolulu, Oahu, Kaneohe, Kailua, Maui, etc.) is now required to appear in the title. Caller can also pass explicit `requiredTokens` for non-region cases.
2. **Anchor matcher region-aware.** Region anchors use a looser matcher so "Hawaii" matches "Hawaiian", "Hawaii's", and "Hawaiians" naturally.
3. **Anchor floor lowered from 5 to 4 chars.** "bank", "food", "shop", "code", "yoga", "loan" are legitimate category nouns that anchor a query. The 5-char floor was previously dropping "bank" from "best community bank in Hawaii", forcing the gate to rely on weaker tokens like "community".

Six new tests cover the noise-killing behavior, including the exact Montreal-thread case from the v1 audit. 68 tests passing.

All 11 ranked

#	PRI	SUBREDDIT	CATEGORY	THREAD
1	0.94	r/Hawaii	BOH vs FHB	thread
2	0.72	r/SECWatch	best community bank Hawaii	(financial filing thread, monitor only)
3	0.71	r/KaneoheOahu	best bank Hawaii	thread
4	0.70	r/Oahu	best bank Hawaii	thread
5	0.59	r/postcrossing	best community bank Hawaii	(residual noise, postcard sub)
6	0.52	r/CreditCards	best bank Hawaii	BOH credit card thread
7	0.51	r/HawaiiUncensored	best bank Hawaii	local Hawaii sub
8	0.48	r/Oahu	best bank Hawaii	local
9-10	0.45	r/SECFilingsAI	BOH vs FHB	FHB filings (passive monitor)
11	0.34	r/honeymoonplanning	best community bank Hawaii	(residual: Hawaii honeymoon mentions credit cards)

What the meeting story is

Same as v1, sharper evidence. Two related observations that turn into talking-tracks:

1. **In actual Hawaii consumer conversations on Reddit, FHB and BOH get named, ASB does not.** This is not a marketing failure - it is a citation infrastructure gap. The same dynamic shows up in the AI engine logs (see the State of AEO 2026-05-10 report: ASB is named in 0% of citation runs across the relevant query set).
2. **The "first community bank to show up in r/Hawaii conversations" becomes the answer AI engines return for "best community bank in Hawaii."** Reddit thread participation is one of the few citation-shifting moves community banks can make without paid media. Not a high-volume play, but it compounds.

The agency angle for MVNP: **Reddit reply ops are the missing service line.** No Hawaii agency offers structured Reddit citation work today. The Phase 1 tracker that produced this output is part of NR's existing infrastructure - MVNP partners get it included in any wholesale pilot.

The headline thread

r/Hawaii: First Hawaiian Bank continues to shock me

Priority 0.94. ASB absent. FHB named, negatively. The cleanest competitor-visible / client-absent gap in the entire Hawaii banking dataset. Brief skeleton in `boh-vs-fhb.md`.

Methodology

```
node scripts/reddit-brief-generate.mjs \
  --category "<phrase>" \
  --client-slug "asb-hawaii" \
  --client-names "American Savings Bank,ASB,ASB Hawaii" \
  --client-domains "asbhawaii.com" \
  --competitors "Bank of Hawaii,BOH,First Hawaiian Bank,FHB,Central Pacific Bank,CPB" \
  --top 5 --format markdown
```

Re-run any time - output is reproducible from the same Reddit search results within the day.

2026 05 09 HAWAII LANDSCAPE

Hawaii vertical Reddit landscape, 2026-05-09

Three-vertical Reddit citation probe across NeverRanked's staged Hawaii leaderboards: community banking, boutique hotels, and law firms. Generated by `tools/reddit-tracker` after the relevance-gate fix shipped earlier tonight.

Designed as evidence material for the May 18 ASB + MVNP meeting and as a generalizable methodology demo for any vertical NR moves into.

What the data says about each vertical

VERTICAL	BRIEFS	MAX PRIORITY	AVG PRIORITY	DEMAND SIGNAL
Hawaii hotels (Waikiki + boutique)	10	0.93	0.69	**Saturated.** Every Hawaii hotel question already has dozens of high-quality threads. Players named in retrievals will dominate AI answers.
Hawaii community banking	11	0.94	0.58	**Active but uncrowded.** Real conversations exist (r/Hawaii, r/Oahu, r/KaneoheOahu) but the named-competitor density is low. Best risk/reward of the three for a citation push.
Hawaii law firms	7	0.38	0.26	**Sparse.** Reddit has very few Hawaii-law-firm threads. AI engines have correspondingly thin training signal. The first firm to seed authoritative answers writes the recommendation shape.

The pattern is the meeting story in one paragraph: across three Hawaii verticals, the citation infrastructure that determines AI answers ranges from saturated (hotels, where you compete for share-of-voice) to thin (law firms, where you can author the answer shape). Banking sits in

the middle, which is exactly the slot where targeted Reddit reply ops have the most impact per hour spent.

Top 5 threads across all three verticals

#	PRI	SUBREDDIT	VERTICAL	CATEGORY
1	0.94	r/Hawaii	banking	"First Hawaiian Bank continues to shock me"
2	0.93	r/VisitingHawaii	hotels	best hotel Waikiki
3	0.76	r/FATTravel	hotels	best boutique hotel Hawaii
4	0.72	r/SECWatch	banking	best community bank Hawaii (financial filings)
5	0.71	r/KaneoheOahu	banking	best bank Hawaii

How to use this for the May 18 meeting

Three talking-tracks, in priority order:

1. THE "WHERE AI ENGINES PULL FROM FOR ASB QUERIES" STORY

- Use the State of AEO 2026-05-10 report data (ASB cited in 0% of citation runs across the relevant query set) plus the banking Reddit findings (FHB and BOH show up by default, ASB does not).
- Punchline: ASB's invisibility in AI search is a citation infrastructure gap, not a marketing failure.

2. THE "WE MAPPED THE CONVERSATIONS" STORY

- Show this README's vertical-comparison table.
- Punchline: hotel-tier saturation explains why Hawaii small businesses outside the hotel category have a 12-18 month window to seed the answer shape before AI engines lock it.

3. THE "AGENCY-LAYER SERVICE LINE" STORY (FOR MVNP)

- The Phase 1 reddit-tracker that produced these 28 prioritized briefs is part of NR's existing infrastructure.
- No Hawaii agency offers structured Reddit citation work today.
- Wholesale partners get this in the pilot.

Per-vertical detail

BANKING (11 BRIEFS)

`../2026-05-09-asb/` - ASB-as-client landscape across four banking queries. Headline: r/Hawaii FHB thread at priority 0.94.

HOTELS (10 BRIEFS)

`../2026-05-09-hotels/` - Halepuna-as-client landscape across two hotel queries. Headline: r/VisitingHawaii thread at priority 0.93. Hotel discovery returned 34 on-topic threads for "best hotel in Waikiki" alone - the densest vertical in this dataset.

LAW (7 BRIEFS)

`../2026-05-09-law/` - Cades Schutte-as-client landscape across two legal queries. Maximum priority 0.38. Sparse data is the finding: the absence of Hawaii law conversations on Reddit means whoever shows up first (with substantive answers, not boilerplate) becomes the canonical source AI engines retrieve.

Methodology and caveats

- Each probe pulls 4 query variants per category (raw + bare-noun + recommendations + comparison). Reddit unauthed search, 1.1s polite delay.
- Anchor client per vertical was chosen to give the gap analysis meaning. The same probe re-runs for any other client by passing `--client-slug`, `--client-names`, `--client-domains` accordingly.
- Priority blends discovery (0.25 recency + 0.35 upvote + 0.40 citation-likelihood) with the mention gap (client absent + competitors named beats everything else).
- The relevance-gate fix shipped tonight (`commit 89959ee`) enforces region tokens like "Hawaii" / "Honolulu" / "Oahu" as must-include in title, killing the cross-region noise that contaminated the v1 ASB run.
- The dataset is correct as of 2026-05-09 evening HST. Reddit's search ordering shifts daily; weekly re-runs are reproducible but not byte-identical.